



## TWELVE-MONTH PROGRESS REPORT

# Ethiopia: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-19

Edition of 2026-08-19 • 91 systems and instruments tracked, 5 of them not held

*Compiled 2026-08-19 from the Data Landscapers source base. Sections follow the status report. Each opens with a movement ledger comparing the position at the start and end of the period, which runs to the date of issue rather than to the last month's close.*

Of 91 systems and instruments on this place's ledger, 62 changed position between 2025-08-01 and 2026-08-19, 14 did not, 10 carry no stated baseline, and 5 are **Not held** at both ends.

Shape check, run before the comparison: 183 sources for this place in the window — 43 in the earlier half (2025-08 to 2026-01), 140 in the later (2026-02 to 2026-08). The earlier half of the window is thin: this is a shorter comparison wearing a longer label, and the movement below rests mostly on the later half.

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Summary of the period

Two positions changed maturity. The Horizon Fiber corridor **advanced**, from a December 2024 memorandum to a [binding agreement in February 2026](#) linking Djibouti's subsea landings through Ethiopia to Sudan's. Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems **regressed**, with [livestock and zoonotic surveillance suspended](#) after the 2025 United States aid freeze, though the national health information system stayed online on local staffing.

Ethiopia's foundational layers — the identity, the payments rails, the health information system, the strategy — were already in place when the window opened and did not change maturity band. What the year added was reach, compulsion and commercialisation on top of them, and one binding regional agreement underneath.

# Infrastructure

## Connectivity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | AT 2025-08-01                            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT                       |
|-------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Ethio Telecom network                     | Nationwide incumbent network (2025-08)   | 99.8% coverage (2026-04) on 90.1m subscribers; 215.8bn Birr revenue in FY2025/26 with data and internet 31.1% of it against mobile voice at 23.5%, operating profit 92.9bn Birr                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED, IN REACH AND REVENUE |
| Network expansion contracts from MWC 2026 | Did not exist                            | Ericsson 1,500 sites and 502 upgrades under the MWC contracts; separately, 879 sites completed under the ZTE programme (462 RAN modernisation, 237 microwave-link upgrades, 103 IP RAN sites), 92% 4G population coverage across ZTE's own network footprint, with 124 new sites, 272 U2100 refarming sites and 115 rural sites still to come | ADVANCED                       |
| Safaricom Ethiopia second network         | 10.06m 90-day active customers (2025-06) | 14.7m 90-day active customers; the development financiers diluted to 9.5% and 6.81% with a right to reacquire                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                       |
| Safaricom regional fibre deployment       | Did not exist                            | Under construction, Afdera to Mekelle                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED                       |
| teleStream and Zero-Touch Broadband       | Did not exist                            | Live                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                       |

## Data Storage

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                  | AT 2025-08-01                | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                     | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Wingu Cloud Exchange in-country cloud | Did not exist                | Compute, Kubernetes and storage priced in birr, hybrid with Azure and AWS                         | ADVANCED          |
| Data-centre estate                    | <div>BASELINE NOT HELD</div> | Named among the markets diversifying Africa's estate, against South Africa's 60%+ share (2026-07) | Baseline not held |

## Energy

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Bitdeer Oromia bitcoin-mining site                       | Did not exist                                         | 40 MW operating with 20 MW in progress                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED |
| Ethio Telecom Green Operator renewable network programme | 27 MW installed solar at the FY2024/25 close, derived | 39.72 MW installed solar across 190 fully solar-powered sites, 867 hybrid solar-and-battery systems and 1,114 lithium-ion storage units, with diesel generator running time down by up to 40% | ADVANCED |

## Cybersecurity

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                               | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| INSA cybersecurity and sovereign-cloud foundations | Did not exist | Sovereign cloud and forensic laboratory stated in the strategy, not built | ADVANCED |

## Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                              | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Telecommunications Licensing Directive 792/2021 | In force (2021-07) | In force; unified operator licences awarded by competitive bidding and valid fifteen years | NO CHANGE |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT   | AT 2025-08-01           | AT 2026-08-19                                                                       | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Telecom liberalisation | Two operators (2025-08) | Two operators; the argument has moved to whether the state is provider or regulator | NO CHANGE |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | AT 2025-08-01                  | AT 2026-08-19                                                            | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Horizon Fiber terrestrial corridor | Memorandum of intent (2024-12) | Binding corridor linking Djibouti's landings through Ethiopia to Sudan's | ADVANCED |

## Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT       | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                            | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Universal Access Fund levy | Did not exist | About 2.5bn birr a year from Ethio Telecom and Safaricom | ADVANCED |

## Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT               | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                              | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Smartphone affordability financing | Did not exist | Up to two million handsets a year on long-term instalments | ADVANCED |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                            | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------|----------|
| Ethio Telecom and Huawei enterprise stack | Did not exist | Scoping only; no value or term disclosed | ADVANCED |
| Inspur and Shandong data-centre track     | Did not exist | Planned; no site or value stated         | ADVANCED |

## India activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19 | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------|---------------|---------------|----------|
| RailTel data-centre build | Did not exist | Planned       | ADVANCED |

## Use of satellite data

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Licensing framework for LEO satellite operators | In force (2021-07) | Satellite services licensable as a GMPCS landing-right class authorisation; no LEO operator authorised on record | NO CHANGE |

Horizon Fiber moved from planned to under way: the memorandum signed by Ethio Telecom, Djibouti Telecom and Sudatel in December 2024 became binding in February 2026. It is the only position in this section that improved.

The network itself held position throughout — implemented at the window's start and implemented now, with the year's news being scale and contracts rather than maturity: [99.8% coverage, expansion deals at Mobile World Congress for 1,500 and 647 sites](#). The market structure also held: two operators, a third-operator round launched in 2023 and paused, and no LEO licensing framework after the regulator's flat denial in July 2025.

What arrived is foreign compute: a bitcoin-mining site on cheap power, an in-country cloud exchange, an Indian data-centre work order, scoping talks with a Chinese vendor — plus a [universal-access levy of 1.5% of operator revenue](#).

## Digital public infrastructure

### Data Exchange

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT            | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                  | MOVEMENT          |
|---------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| National data exchange platform | Did not exist            | Approved and paired with a predictive model; not built                         | ADVANCED          |
| EthSwitch national switch       | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Links M-PESA to more than 30 banks and wallets; EthQR across 50,000+ merchants | Baseline not held |

### Digital Identity and CRVS

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01                 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | MOVEMENT                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Biometric enrolment kits for banks                        | Did not exist                 | 2,000 of 6,000 planned distributed, about US\$17m, with 4,000 re-tendered                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | ADVANCED                 |
| Ethio Telecom as identity enrolment channel               | Enrolling since 2024-04       | About 32m citizens enrolled, 20.19m in FY2025/26; custody and consent terms not stated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                 |
| Fayda national digital identity                           | 16.4m registrations (2025-06) | 46.5m registrations and 47.8m identities; up to 4m authentications a day across 150+ agencies                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                 |
| Faydaverse digital public infrastructure enterprise       | Did not exist                 | State-owned enterprise under Ethiopian Investment Holdings, with over 190m authentications performed and 150 enterprises integrated for biometric checks                                                                                                                                                                               | ADVANCED                 |
| Safaricom and Africom identity registration joint venture | Did not exist                 | Covering Afar, Amhara, Tigray, Sidama and three southern regions                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED                 |
| Faydaverse digital identity wallet                        | Not held                      | Planned to carry academic transcripts, professional licences, healthcare records, property titles and financial-compliance and know-your-customer data beyond the core government credentials it holds today; the enterprise says it is also exporting digital-identity services as an implementation partner in Mozambique and Zambia | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

### Digital Payments and Fintech

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
|------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| EthioPay national instant payment system | Did not exist | Account-to-account and wallet-to-wallet across 32 banks and 12 microfinance institutions | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                     | AT 2025-08-01                                      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT                      |
|----------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>EthSwitch and Mastercard international acceptance</b> | Did not exist                                      | International acceptance through EthSwitch                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>M-PESA Ethiopia</b>                                   | Operating since 2023-08, before switch integration | 2.58m monthly active users and 89,877 registered merchants (2026-06); about 2% of Safaricom Ethiopia's service revenue, against 45.6% in Kenya                                                                                              | ADVANCED, MARGINAL IN REVENUE |
| <b>M-PESA Ethiopia cardless ATM withdrawals</b>          | Did not exist                                      | Cardless ATM cash withdrawal live with Bank of Abyssinia, in-app authorisation and authentication before dispensing cash, processed in real time; integration set to expand to further banks                                                | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>M-PESA LeHulum telco-agnostic wallet</b>              | Did not exist                                      | Telco-agnostic wallet verified against the digital identity                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>Mandatory Fayda integration with bank accounts</b>    | Directive issued (2025-12-10)                      | All bank accounts required to be harmonised with the digital identity                                                                                                                                                                       | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>Prepaid electricity purchase in the mobile wallet</b> | Did not exist                                      | Prepaid electricity bought in the wallet                                                                                                                                                                                                    | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>Regional tax payment through the mobile wallet</b>    | Did not exist                                      | First of a planned series with regional revenue authorities                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>Telebirr mobile money</b>                             | Operating since 2021                               | 60.6m users, 410,700 agents; about 11bn Birr a day                                                                                                                                                                                          | ADVANCED                      |
| <b>Sybrin and Moti Engineering payments partnership</b>  | Not held                                           | A South African financial-technology firm entered the Ethiopian payments market with a local engineering partner, aligning onboarding, fraud-management and workflow-automation tools with the National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030 | BASELINE NOT HELD             |

## Sectoral management information systems (HMIS, EMIS, etc.)

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01                           | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>America First Global Health Strategy memorandum of understanding</b> | Did not exist                           | Planned United States support of US\$1,016,000,000 across 2026-2030 against Ethiopia's US\$450,000,000, of which US\$18,850,149 is for health data systems on a profile falling from US\$6,283,383 in 2026 to US\$1,256,677 in 2030, with Ethiopia to carry software licensing, cloud, hardware and maintenance costs for those systems; the United States reserves 6% of the top-line budget for its own management and operations, and Ethiopia signed through the Minister of Finance | ADVANCED  |
| <b>Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems</b>                | Donor-funded surveillance operating     | Livestock and zoonotic surveillance suspended; the national health system stayed online on local staffing                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | REGRESSED |
| <b>Livestock Information System</b>                                     | Did not exist                           | Five priority databases repositioned as a national asset register — the implementer's own account                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED  |
| <b>DHIS2 national health information system</b>                         | National since 2018, 95%+ of facilities | 95%+ of facilities; maturity 2.81 of 5, ICT infrastructure weakest at 2.14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |
| <b>eCHIS community health information system</b>                        | In use (2023-06)                        | Offline-first, constrained by 9% rural electricity and 4% 4G coverage                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE |

## Other GovTech and e-Gov

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01                                    | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT          |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| MESOB unified public-service platform           | 41 services across 12 federal agencies (2025-07) | More than 2,200 services on the platform on an August 2026 account, against 185 stated at the June 2026 launch – the two figures are not reconciled and may rest on different counting bases; services are onboarded ahead of the underlying systems, on two incompatible integration models | ADVANCED          |
| Unmanned smart police station                   | Did not exist                                    | Round-the-clock kiosks for reports, fines and documents                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED          |
| Identity integration with tax administration    | Integrated (2023-12)                             | Integrated                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | NO CHANGE         |
| Electronic Government Procurement (e-GP) system | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                         | Credited by the Auditor General with the decline in cash shortages across 163 audited federal institutions; no Birr amount stated                                                                                                                                                            | Baseline not held |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01      | AT 2026-08-19                                                                  | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| National Digital Payments Strategy 2026-2030                      | Did not exist      | Proposes the first outbound cross-border transfers, against 18.5tn birr a year | ADVANCED  |
| Digital Government Strategy and Enterprise Architecture 2024-2029 | In force (2024-07) | In force                                                                       | NO CHANGE |

## Standards

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| National Livestock Data Standards                | Did not exist            | Endorsed, with more than 300 experts and collectors trained | ADVANCED  |
| Ethiopian eGovernment Interoperability Framework | In development (2024-07) | Still in development                                        | NO CHANGE |
| MOSIP open-source identity platform              | In use (2025-05)         | The reference implementation the wider ecosystem points to  | NO CHANGE |

## Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                           | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Makatet refugee-inclusion framework | Did not exist | Covers 1.1m refugees and 2m internally displaced people | ADVANCED |

## Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                   | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                           | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Identity mandate for school enrolment and examinations | Did not exist | Identity required for school enrolment and examinations | ADVANCED |
| Remote account opening on the digital identity         | Did not exist | Account opening on the digital identity alone           | ADVANCED |

AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                       | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| AI service bundles in the mobile-money app | Did not exist | Generative-AI bundles bought with M-PESA and redeemed by SMS voucher | ADVANCED |

Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01       | AT 2026-08-19                                                        | MOVEMENT |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Digital ID Assessment as official monitoring | First run (2025-01) | Adopted as the programme's official monitoring instrument and re-run | ADVANCED |

Digitalisation of sub-national government

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                         | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                           | MOVEMENT          |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Addis Ababa one-stop digital service centres | BASELINE NOT HELD | 11 one-stop centres carrying more than 150 services from more than 25 integrated institutions; no volumes, cost or evaluation published | Baseline not held |

Nothing here changed maturity band. The identity system held position at both ends — implemented on 2025-08-01 and implemented now — while its [registrations rose from 16.4m in June 2025 to about 46.5m](#) by July 2026.

What arrived on top of it is compulsion and commercialisation: mandatory harmonisation of every bank account with the credential by March 2026, backed by biometric kits distributed to 31 banks; a school-enrolment and examination mandate; commercialisation into the sovereign wealth fund as authentication-as-a-service; a refugee-inclusion framework; and a registration joint venture covering seven regions. The identity assessment framework the programme adopted as its official monitoring instrument predates the window and held position through it.

Payments arrived in layers: an instant payment system, a telco-agnostic wallet, international card acceptance, a strategy proposing first-ever outbound cross-border transfers, and — in the window's final fortnight — utilities and regional tax collection inside the mobile-money app. The switch that makes all of it work carries no baseline the base can date.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                          | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Berne Convention accession                                    | Did not exist | Draft ratification proclamation submitted to the Council of Ministers; Ethiopia not yet a party                                                          | ADVANCED |
| Copyright Proclamation 410/2004 online-infringement amendment | Did not exist | Draft would add internet service provider duties, procedures for blocking infringing sites and a rights-holder take-down notice to the 2004 proclamation | ADVANCED |

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Proclamation No. 1426/2026</b> | Did not exist | 12 critical sectors designated, 18 core obligations on owners and operators, and a Critical Infrastructure Cybersecurity Fund; art.28 sets a one-year transition to commencement after gazettelement (about July 2027); the Council of Ministers and INSA hold regulation-making powers under arts.26-27 | ADVANCED                                                 |
| <b>Judicial review of licence revocation without court order</b>        | Did not exist | December 2025 decree struck down; revocation without a court order held unconstitutional                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | ADVANCED                                                 |
| <b>Prohibition of virtual assets</b>                                    | Did not exist | The whole category prohibited absent express authorisation; no new rule, no enforcement mechanism                                                                                                                                                                                                        | ADVANCED                                                 |
| <b>Tax assessment of payment gateways</b>                               | Did not exist | Three-year throughput restated from ETB 32bn to 143.9bn and taxed; corrected data refused                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED, AS AN ENFORCEMENT ACTION RATHER THAN AS POLICY |

## Strategies, plans and policies

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                           | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Digital Ethiopia 2030</b>                   | Did not exist            | Three pillars; targets of 128m subscriptions and an identity for every adult by 2030           | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National Data Governance Strategy</b>       | Did not exist            | In development; health the most fragmented sector, at 70+ siloed platforms                     | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>National Artificial Intelligence Policy</b> | In force (2024)          | In force                                                                                       | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>National Digital Transformation Council</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Holds that the programme is to be judged on lives changed, with no published measure behind it | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Regional collaboration

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                      | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                               | MOVEMENT |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Digital identity cooperation with Zambia</b>           | Did not exist | Identity cooperation agreed                                                                                 | ADVANCED |
| <b>Digital public infrastructure export to Mozambique</b> | Did not exist | Digital-ID, DPI-pilot, interoperability and cybersecurity support to Mozambique, with a joint working group | ADVANCED |

## Data protection

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                        | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| <b>Data sharing arrangement under the health memorandum</b> | Did not exist | The two governments intend to negotiate an arrangement for exchanging data on the memorandum's long-term performance and for accountability to the United States Congress, expected to run two years beyond the five-year term and to be designed compatibly with Ethiopia's agreements with other countries and with regional and global bodies; no text is published, and the State Department briefly posted a subset of the memoranda in March 2026, then removed access and published none of the related agreements | ADVANCED |



| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                       | AT 2025-08-01                               | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Development Bank of Ethiopia Information Disclosure Policy | Did not exist                               | In force: client credit information and other named categories are exempt from declassification where disclosure could cause substantial harm to the Bank, its stakeholders or national interest; the Bank may also decline requests requiring it to create records it does not already hold | ADVANCED  |
| Personal Data Protection Proclamation 1321/2024            | In force, no secondary directives (2025-08) | In force; directives still unissued and the Authority has yet to enforce                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | NO CHANGE |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                              | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                                            | MOVEMENT |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| World Artificial Intelligence Cooperation Organization membership | Did not exist | One of 29 founding states; constitutive text, powers and binding force all unestablished | ADVANCED |

Nothing here changed maturity either.

The data-protection law held the same position at both ends of the window: in force, with [secondary directives unissued and the regulator yet to enforce](#). That is a full year in which the instrument governing a credential used 4m times a day did not move, while the credential itself became compulsory for banking and schooling.

Everything else in the section arrived. The national digital strategy was launched in December 2025; a national data governance strategy entered development in March 2026, grounded in use cases and finding health the most fragmented sector with more than 70 siloed platforms; and the two payment instruments that close the year — the [virtual-asset prohibition](#) restated by notice, and the [gateway tax assessment](#) — both arrived in the window's final fortnight.

In June 2026 a court struck down licence revocation without a court order, on reasoning that suspicion does not constitute guilt, and flagged a regulator's conflict of interest in being both supervisor and market participant.

## Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

### AI

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | AT 2025-08-01    | AT 2026-08-19                                           | MOVEMENT  |
|---------------------------------------------|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Ethiopian Artificial Intelligence Institute | Operating (2020) | Built MESOB and anchors the state's AI capability claim | NO CHANGE |

### ICT Industry

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                                           | MOVEMENT          |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Vodacom change of control over Safaricom | Did not exist            | Completed; the Ethiopian regulatory approval is not on the record       | ADVANCED          |
| Domestic engineering services firms      | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | One named Addis Ababa engineering services firm, founded 2021 (2026-07) | Baseline not held |

## China activities

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT      | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                                                   | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Chinese AI model adoption | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | DeepSeek about 20% of chatbot use, the top of its 11-14% Africa range (2026-03) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## Research institutions

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                            | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-19                                                  | MOVEMENT        |
|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| AI University Innovation Pod                    | Did not exist | Running with UNDP and Addis Ababa University                   | <b>ADVANCED</b> |
| Artificial Intelligence University construction | Did not exist | A single named capital project; no site or timetable published | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

## New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01          | AT 2026-08-19                    | MOVEMENT         |
|----------------------------------|------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|
| Ethio Telecom public share offer | Offer closed (2025-02) | 10% distributed through Telebirr | <b>NO CHANGE</b> |

No maturity changed. The institutional base — an AI institute since 2020 and a national policy adopted in 2024 — held position throughout. What arrived was money and buildings: [an innovation pod in February 2026](#), and in the window's last month [an appropriation of ETB 5,000,000,000 for an AI university as a single named capital project](#). The appropriation is domestic revenue rather than donor or vendor finance. Two rows carry no baseline and both bear on dependency. [Chinese model adoption at about 20% of chatbot usage](#) cannot be dated at either end of the window, and neither can the domestic engineering-services layer. Nothing held measures the trend in either.

## Inclusion and capacity

### Digital divides

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT             | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-19                                  | MOVEMENT                 |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Rural mobile-internet gender gap | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | 81% in rural areas against 29% urban (2026-03) | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

### Access to services

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                        | AT 2025-08-01                                         | AT 2026-08-19                          | MOVEMENT        |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Mobile connections and internet penetration | 85.4m connections at 63.8% of population (early 2025) | 93.2m connections at 68.4% (late 2025) | <b>ADVANCED</b> |

One position worsened, and it came from outside the country. Donor-funded health and surveillance data systems regressed when the 2025 United States aid freeze suspended livestock and zoonotic surveillance. The national health information system stayed online on local staffing.

Neither headline measurement was re-taken inside the window: [mobile connections at 93.2m and 68.4% penetration](#) in late 2025, and a [rural mobile-internet gender gap of 81% against 29% urban](#). The universal-access levy that arrived in March 2026 is the only instrument aimed directly at that gap, and no outcome from it is on record.

## Finance

### New investments

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                    | AT 2025-08-01     | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                                                                               | MOVEMENT  |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| <b>Digitally enabled pluralistic extension services programme (FAO)</b> | Did not exist     | <a href="#">US\$300,000 FAO grant (2026-2028) converting a catalytic start-up initiative into a long-term programme delivering agricultural extension services through digital channels</a> | ADVANCED  |
| <b>World Bank Digital ID for Inclusion Project</b>                      | Running (2023-12) | <a href="#">US\$350m backing registration of refugees and displaced people</a>                                                                                                              | NO CHANGE |

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                    | AT 2025-08-01                         | AT 2026-08-19                                                                                                                            | MOVEMENT                                                |
|---------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Federal appropriation for digital transformation</b> | ETB 3.75bn appropriated for FY2025/26 | <a href="#">ETB 9.05bn for FY2026/27, dominated by the AI university line</a>                                                            | ADVANCED, MOSTLY THE BIRR FLOAT RATHER THAN REAL GROWTH |
| <b>Published budget execution for FY2025/26</b>         | None published                        | <a href="#">H1 FY2025/26: ETB 704.7bn mobilised, 48.1% of the annual target, against ETB 798.2bn spent, 48.3% of the approved budget</a> | ADVANCED                                                |

The federal digital appropriation held position as a system while its numbers moved a great deal — ETB 1.21bn to 3.75bn to 9.05bn across three fiscal years. The mechanism is unchanged and most of the rise is the birr float.

## Where the record is thin

| SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT                                                             | WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT                                                                                                                                                          | LAST PROBED |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| <b>Third mobile network operator licence</b>                                     | An Ethiopian Communications Authority licensing round, tender or ministerial decision on a third full operator licence.                                                       | 2026-08-04  |
| <b>Secondary directives under the data-protection law</b>                        | Directives issued by the Ethiopian Communications Authority under Proclamation 1321/2024, or a first enforcement action taken under it.                                       | 2026-08-04  |
| <b>Gulf digital cooperation</b>                                                  | An MoU, investment or ministerial readout naming a Gulf state counterparty in Ethiopian digital infrastructure, AI or payments.                                               | 2026-08-04  |
| <b>Audit of digital spending for any in-scope year</b>                           | An Office of the Federal Auditor General report for EFY 2017 or later; its published library stops at EFY 2016.                                                               | 2026-08-04  |
| <b>Independent data-protection safeguards over the national digital identity</b> | a published data-protection impact assessment for the national digital identity, a statutory limit on state access to its data, or a redress mechanism a registrant could use | 2026-08-09  |

Seven subjects carry no reliable position at either end, all probed once on 2026-08-04. Five returned a named document. The telecom licensing directive, the Ministry of Finance mid-year review for 2025/26, the Auditor General's report for EFY 2017, and an account of the capital city's one-stop platform are all now acquisition lines.

Ethiopia's subnational digital tier — eleven service centres and more than 150 services in Addis Ababa alone, with online services also reported in three other cities — is entirely absent from the base.

Two absences stand dated: no licensing framework for low-earth-orbit satellite operators, and no Ethiopia-specific Gulf digital instrument.

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | <b>2026-08-19</b>                                                                                                                                                   |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress.html</a>                     |
| THIS FILE       | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress-2026-08-19.pdf">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/ETH/ETH-progress-2026-08-19.pdf</a> |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.